# AI Bootcamp — Week 1: Foundations

*Thursday — Student Exercise Guide*


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## OBJECTIVES

By end of Week 1, the candidate can:

- Explain the Prompt/Harness/Model framework and why the harness, not the model, controls what a skill can do
- Apply the EDD (Evaluation-Driven Development) discipline: write Evaluation Criteria (EC) and manual test cases before building any skill
- Explain and apply the RTCC prompt structure (Role = WHO, Task = WHAT, Context = WHY, Constraints = HOW) to a real skill
- Build four sequential content creation skills as durable, committed `.skill.md` files
- Direct an AI to write a Python evaluation script (deterministic checks plus an LLM judge) and interpret its results
- Verify that every instruction in a skill is load-bearing using manual tests and evaluation runs
- Produce a working end-to-end content pipeline: Trend Identification → Ideation → Development → Graphics


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## TIMING

- **Monday:** 1:00 PM – 5:00 PM (travel morning, 4 hours)
- **Tuesday–Thursday:** 9:00 AM – 5:00 PM with 1-hour lunch (7 hours each)
- **Friday:** 9:00 AM – 12:00 PM (travel afternoon, 3 hours)


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# THURSDAY (9:00 AM – 5:00 PM): DEVELOPMENT SKILL

## 9:00 – 10:00 AM — EDD FIRST: WRITE THE DEVELOPMENT TEST FILE

**Skill 3: Development:**

- **Input:** A selected post idea from `ideas.md`
- **Output file:** `post.md`: a fully developed social media post ready for review and scheduling
- **Required output elements:** Post body (platform-appropriate length), hashtags (platform-appropriate count and style), call to action, target platform(s), audience segment, content warnings or tone notes if applicable

Define your EC before building. Be specific about what "platform-appropriate" means for each platform you test against: LinkedIn is not X/Twitter is not Instagram. These are separate, testable criteria.

## 10:00 AM – 1:00 PM — BUILD, EVALUATE, FULL EDD CYCLE

Build the Development skill. Have the AI generate the evaluation script from your EC before the first run. Full Red/Green/Refactor cycle. Minimum: 4 evaluation runs with documented hypotheses. After achieving Green, perform the load-bearing audit.

## 1:00 – 2:00 PM — LUNCH

## 2:00 – 4:00 PM — THREE-SKILL PIPELINE RUN

Run the full pipeline: Trend Identification → Ideation → Development. Produce a complete `post.md` from a raw topic area. Evaluate the end-to-end quality.

Discussion: Where in the pipeline did quality degrade most? What would you fix first and why?

## 4:00 – 5:00 PM — REFLECTION: WHAT MAKES AN INSTRUCTION EARN ITS PLACE

Group discussion. Each candidate picks the instruction they are most surprised turned out to be load-bearing, and the one they were most surprised turned out to be dead weight. What does this tell you about how prompts work?


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